UNDERWORLD ENGINE • TEAM BRIEFING

ESCAPE FROM TARTARUS

Complete Game Overview & 3-Round Journey

👥 The 5-Player Crews

- **5 Distinct Roles:** Navigator, Oracle, Scholar, Torchbearer, Negotiator.
- **Simple Identity (No Complex Powers):** Roles serve as crew member identities and tablet puzzle slots. Players don't need to manage complicated abilities.
- **1-Tap Emoji Joining:** One player creates the crew; teammates join by tapping 3 emojis on screen (e.g. Skull • Bolt • Shield).
- **Zero Friction:** No apps to download, no typing, no camera permissions required.

🏆 The Ultimate Objective

- **Rounds 1 & 2 (Points Pool):** Earn points through team physical coordination and tactical room psychology.
- **Starting Head-Start:** Cumulative points convert directly into starting distance meters on the River Styx in Round 3!
- **Podium Victory:** First 3 crews to cross the 1,000-meter exit portal win Gold, Silver, and Bronze medals.
- **High Energy:** The whole experience runs in ~25-30 minutes of fast, social interaction.

0. Lobby Assembly

1. Shattered Tablet

2. Shades in Mist

3. Styx Escape

ROUND 1 • PHYSICAL COOPERATION PUZZLE

THE SHATTERED TABLET

Tomb Gate Alignment • Duration: ~5 Minutes

🏛️ *The Story: Walking through the dark expanse of Tartarus, your crew reaches a sealed ancient stone door. You need a codeword to pass. Pieces of a shattered ancient tablet lie on the ground before you.*

⚙️ Mechanics

- **5 Slices on 5 Phones:** The tablet is split into 5 vertical slices distributed across the crew's phones (#1 to #5).
- **Physical Phone Order:** Players physically place their 5 phones side-by-side in numerical order (#1 to #5) across the table.
- **The Codeword:** Golden carved fracture lines connect across phone borders to reveal a 2-word codeword (e.g. CRIMSON SHADOW).
- **Team Submission:** Any player in the crew can type and submit the answer on their screen.

🏆 Points & Winning Conditions

- **Speed is Rewarded:** Faster team solves earn higher base points (Legendary → Swift → Steady).
- **Guaranteed Safety Floor:** A 50 PTS minimum floor ensures every crew passes through the tomb gate.
- **Round Completion:** The round ends when all crews submit the code or the timer concludes.

💡 **Facilitator Prompt:** "Don't stay seated staring at your own screen—stand up, place your 5 phones in order 1 to 5, and read the tablet together!"

ROUND 2 • PRISONER'S DILEMMA

SHADES IN THE MIST

Prisoner's Dilemma • 3 Clashes • Face-to-Face Negotiation

🏛️ *The Story: You escape through the tomb door into a vast cavern hall as thick Stygian mist rolls in. Another crew of shades emerges from the shadows. Are they trustworthy friends or treacherous enemies?*

⚙️ Mechanics (Each Clash)

Your crew faces a rival table across 3 escalating clashes:

1. Private Huddle (50s): Whisper at your table. Decide your true stance: Truce or Ambush?

2. The Dialogue (40s): Talk with the other team across the room (bluffing is 100% permitted!).

3. Secret Blind Vote (25s): Every player secretly votes on phone. Majority rules (Negotiator breaks ties).

4. The Reveal (40s): Both tables' choices unmask simultaneously on screen!

🏆 Points Difference

Points Outcomes (Stakes DOUBLE in Clash 2, TRIPLE in Clash 3!):

🤝 **Mutual Truce (Cooperation):**
Both teams play peaceful → Both win solid, steady points (+75 / +150 / +225 PTS).

🗡️ **The Backstab (Betrayal):**
Ambush beats Truce → Betrayer steals maximum points (+150 / +300 / +450 PTS); peaceful victim gets 0 PTS!

💥 **Mutual Brawl (Conflict):**
Both teams attack → Both walk away with scraps (+15 / +30 / +45 PTS).

⚠️ *Key Tension: Promises across the room are non-binding. Will you build trust or cash in on a backstab?*

ROUND 3 • ESCAPE ROYALE

ESCAPE FROM TARTARUS

River Styx Congestion Race • 1,000m to the Exit Portal

🏛️ *The Story: Cerberus is howling in the shadows behind you, and the exit portal across the wide River Styx is slowly starting to close. Can your crew reach the portal before it seals forever?*

⚙️ Mechanics: The 3 Vessels

Each wave, your crew secretly votes for one vessel:

🚣 **The Rowboat (Safe):**
• Unlimited capacity. Always advances +150m. Never capsizes.

⛵ **The Sailboat (Speed vs Crowds):**
• Max 30% fleet capacity. Advances +300m, but CAPSIZES (0m) if overcrowded!

⚡ **The Ghost Ship (Solo Gamble):**
• Exactly 1 crew. Mythic surge (+450m)! But COLLIDES (-50m) if 2+ crews board.

🏆 Winning Conditions

• **Starting Head-Start:** Total points accumulated in Rounds 1 & 2 convert directly into starting river meters.

• **The Victory Gate:** First 3 crews to reach 1,000 meters win Gold, Silver & Bronze medals!

• 🐕 **Stygian Leash (Cerberus Revenge):** Tether your rival's boat. If they float: steal 50m. If they crash: drag them down & get +100m! (If your own boat crashes, leash snaps: 0m).

• **Sudden Death Standoff:** Tie-breaker duel (Shields vs Ram vs Sails) if crews cross the portal simultaneously.

FACILITATOR CHEATSHEET • AT A GLANCE

SESSION RUNNING GUIDE

Total Event Runtime: ~25 - 30 Minutes

ROUND	CORE ACTIVITY	HOW POINTS / PROGRESS WORK	COMPLETION
1. Shattered Tablet (~5 min)	Align 5 phones physically (#1 to #5) on table to connect carved fracture lines.	Fast solve = top points. 50 PTS safety floor. No elimination.	Codeword entered or timer expires.
2. Shades in Mist (~8 min)	Prisoner's Dilemma: Face rival table across 3 clashes. Talk across room & vote secretly.	Truce = steady points. Backstab = huge points or 0. Stakes triple in Clash 3.	All 3 clashes resolved.
3. Styx Escape (~8 min)	Congestion race: Pick vessels (Rowboat: safe, Sailboat: 30% cap, Ghost: solo).	Points become starting meters. Avoid congestion and unleash Cerberus revenge.	Top 3 crews cross 1,000m to win Gold, Silver & Bronze medals!

🎮 **Host Operations: Game Master at /admin • Solo sandbox at /solotester**